



A Great Rogue-Lite Game Highlighting The Features Of The PS5

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Returnal is a rogue-lite game, i.e., it has some elements of a roguelike game but not all. Rogue-lites add elements like carrying over abilities or making permanent changes to player abilities which will be carried forward with each run. If you love games like Hades or Control then you will definitely find appeal in what Returnal has to offer. For me, Returnal has been an adventure. I don't remember the last time I leapt off my seat to rejoice in a victorious boss battle or felt so immersed in a game thanks to the controller. Returnal is one of the first games to show us what the PS5 can do and it looks like it's just the tip of the iceberg.

STORY

The story of Returnal sounds straightforward when you start. But it's only when you progress far enough that the plot truly starts to unfold. You don't play the role of a Space Scout, Selene, who has crash-landed on a hostile alien planet Atropos. You must explore the

planet to “Locate the ‘White Shadow’ Broadcast.” In the first minute of the game, you come across yourself lying dead on the ground and in the next 10 minutes you will face a foe who kills you in a matter of seconds and you awaken at the crash site once again. This live-die-repeat formula feels a lot like the movie Edge of Tomorrow. Not only because of the time loop but because the foes in the game look a lot like the aliens from the movie.

Throughout your journey, you will find Scout Logs left behind by Selene probably from a previous run. It is these scout logs that not only give you a hint as to what's coming next but also highlight the mental state of the protagonist. Some of it feels contradictory to what the Selene you are playing feels and it is in these moments of Selene talking to herself that you understand some of the depth the story brings. For the first couple of hours, the story feels like a slow burn and that's ok as the game is helping you come to grips with the various mechanics and it's only once

you've endured through the time loop a bunch of times that the story starts to unfold.

Once in a while, you will visit a house where the perspective changes to first-person view and this is where you have some of the more intimate story moments.

GAMEPLAY

Returnal is a third-person action game with a lot of frantic fast-paced gunplay, and before we get into the details of the gameplay, I'd like to highlight some of the features on the DualSense. Returnal really shows off the potential of the DualSense. From the opening cinematic where the ship is crashing, you can feel every rumble shift from one corner of the controller to the other. Even when you are in the first-person view and standing in the rain, you can feel the droplets fall on you thanks to the soft haptic feedback.

The Adaptive Triggers on the DualSense feel like there is a new button on the controller. Half pull the L2 trigger to focus your aim and pull it